

1.2 Common Pitfalls: The Four Approaches That Will Never Work

Before applying the diagnostic lens, confirm you are not defaulting to one of these structurally flawed approaches. Each one treats voice bleed as a single undifferentiated problem rather than five separate, addressable failures.

Approach	What You Do	Why It Fails Structurally	What It Actually Addresses
Vague Re-Prompting	Type "make him sound grumpier" and regenerate	Emotional adjectives shift tone only; they say nothing about cadence, vocabulary, sentence variance, or conversational rhythm	~10% of Emotional Register only
Manual Rewriting	Generate, then rewrite every line by hand	Defeats the purpose of AI as a time-saver; produces no reusable correction	All five dimensions, but at the cost of hours per scene
Style-Mimicry Pasting	Paste a favorite author's paragraph into the prompt	Mimics surface rhythm without the psychological architecture beneath it	Cadence partially; no vocabulary, variance, register, or rhythm
AI Abandonment	Write all dialogue by hand	Surrenders the speed advantage; unsustainable at rapid-release pace	All five dimensions manually; zero scalability

Self-Check: If you catch yourself reaching for any of these four approaches, pause. Run the five-dimensional scan first. Name the failing channels. Then correct with precision.